

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

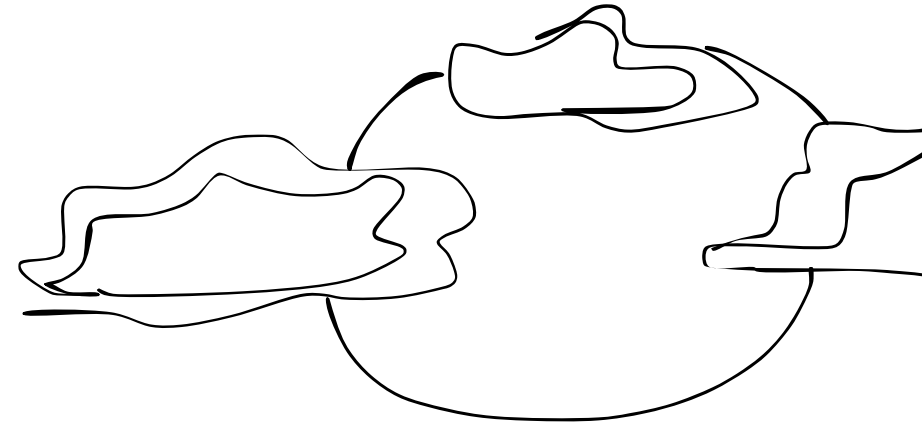
A WEEKLY ZINE

Thank your local downzapper

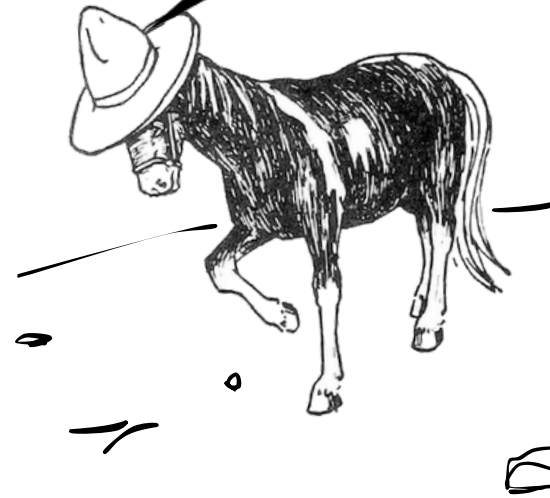
??

SS IS k00b

??



SNZ



ISSUE #48

938 606

\$67626

feb 21 - feb 27

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

ADVENTURES IN DOWNZAPPING



I built a family Bitcoin education app — kids earn sats from chores

17.2k sats \ 18 comments \ [@btcbitbybit](#) 25 Feb
bitcoin_beginners lightning Education



I built a family Bitcoin education app — kids earn sats from chores

Body:

I've been building BTCBitByBit for the past year. It's a family Bitcoin app on iOS and Android with three main pieces:

Self-custody wallet — Lightning, Liquid, and on-chain from one balance. Powered by Breez SDK. It's genuinely awesome!

Learn & Earn — Short courses on Bitcoin and money. Pass the quiz, earn sats to your wallet.

Family Corner — Parents create chores and set sats rewards. Kids complete the task, parent approves, sats go to the child's own self-custody wallet. You can give them full wallet access or keep it earn-only where they can only send sats back to you.

We're in beta right now. Subscribers get 100% of their subscription back in sats every month with code BETA2026.

I'd genuinely appreciate feedback from this community.

What would you want from an app like this? What's missing?

[btcbitbybit.com](#)

stalker meme zone

is a real life publication put together by a real person
to make the quality posts on SN live a long time

BY [@PLEBPOET](#)

WITH [@K00B](#)

note from
the editor

I don't think you all know this, but [@k00b](#) has a set of teeth that would make a TV actor jealous. Does he do a little performing on the side? Well, someone formulated such a thought and deployed it on the back page of this zine.

As for me, I actually have done some acting. And would do more. My teeth are okay.

mutenuke: never see 'reply from someone you muted' again



35.7k sats \ 40 comments \ @ek 22 Feb meta

A few days ago, I created a userscript to never see 'reply from someone you muted' again.

Due to the popular demand here of three other stackers, I decided it's worth making it easier to install and writing a post about it.

I still have to figure out if there's a way to run this in the PWA, too.

mutenuke

Never see 'reply from someone you muted' on Stacker News again.

Installation via userscript extension

1. Install a userscript extension like Tampermonkey
2. Go to the mutenuke page on GreasyFork
3. Click "Install this script"

Installation via Brave Shields

On Brave, you don't need a userscript extension. You can run custom scriptlets within Shields as mentioned [here](#)!

1. Go to brave://settings/shields/filters
2. Enable developer mode
3. Save this as a new custom scriptlet named 'mutenuke':

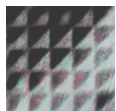
```

window.addEventListener('DOMContentLoaded', () => {
  function mutenuke() {
    document.querySelectorAll('div[class*="comment_collapsed"]')
      .forEach(node => {
        if (node.textContent.startsWith("reply from someone you muted")) node.remove()
      })
  }

  // Run on initial page load
  mutenuke();

  // Watch for dynamically loaded content
  const observer = new MutationObserver(mutenuke);
  observer.observe(document.body, { childList: true, subtree: true });
});

```



4. Save this as a new custom filter:

```
stacker.news###js(user-mutenuke.js)
```

Done!

Installation via Brave Shields will cause React hydration errors, but as far as I know, it doesn't impact the functionality of the site.

but who would do such a nuclear mute?
well..

follow the adventure



Questions, Naivete & SolomonSatoshi: IDEas from the Edge

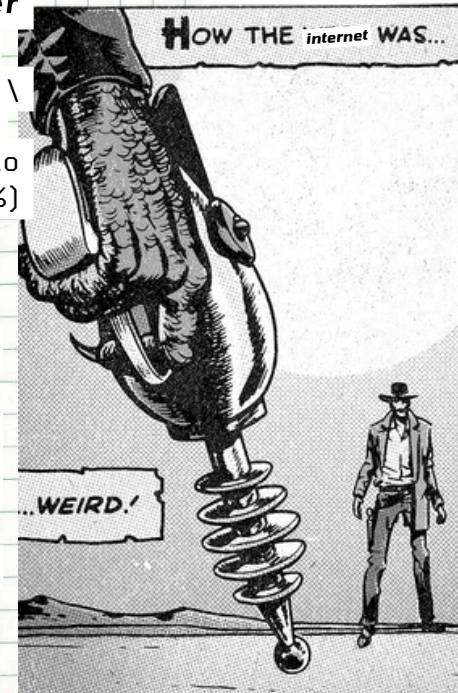
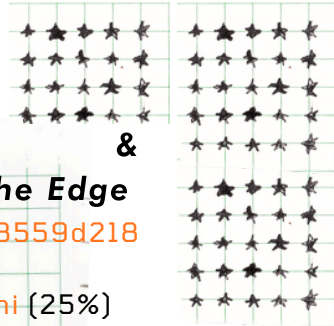
3087 sats \ 53 comments \ @028559d218
20 Feb ideasfromtheedge
zaps forwarded to @Solomonsatoshi (25%)

How about a new filter for downzaped posts?

1273 sats \ 125 comments \ @0xbitcoiner 23 Feb meta
zaps forwarded to @Solomonsatoshi (21%)
@40 (50%)

SN release:
top/posts/<when>?
by=downsats, partial
not-custodial zap
splits

4546 sats \ 49 comments \ @k00b 23 Feb meta



The Economics of Downzapping: Transaction Costs, Custody, and Solomon's Nonsense



15.6k sats \ 67 comments \ @denlillaapan 22
Feb meta econ

I feel adventurous today, so I'm gonna bite the hand that feeds me. *Man, are we enjoying the BIG rewards pots these days #1439195*,. BUT, god knows we're not actually or truly here to *make money* or optimize income so I'm gonna hurl a pebble into this not-very-neatly run machinery.

We're all sick of Solomon's pretty tiresome tirade... (Not that I suffer too much, having had him muted for ages). But like a good horror movie, or a NAKA debacle, I also can't stop watching.

So what's up with the downzapping?

The effort, if I were to steelman it, is to throw good money(?) after bad by trying to bully people with insufficiently noncustodial setups and thereby bring forth true V4V Lightning Network engagements onto the hundred-odd souls hanging out here on SN. We gotta showcase to the world how a bunch of extremely dedicated cypherpunky Bitcoiners can send microscopic payments to each other without custodians.

In a big wide Nostr-Lightning-Bitcoin world of custody and noncustody, business integrations for payments and zaps on various social media, that seems wholly inappropriate and hopeless. Whatever you think you achieve here is tiny and irrelevant.

1. WORSE, it's self-contradictory theatre. Solomon is happy to brag about his CoinOS-derived gun such that he can do the SN transaction noncustodially... but until recently, CoinOS was entirely custodial ([#1428833](#)) – and even now, when it's not, you're not running a Lightning implementation without them. (Maybe, like Phoenix, you have the ability to recoup funds on-chain via back-up words, but that's a *back-up plan*, not "real" Lightning anyway.)

2. My SN activity *also* uses Lightning, though around the edges. The daily reward zap lands in a custodial Lightning wallet of mine from which I periodically make Lightning payments and withdrawals to a more noncustodial setup (Phoenix) where I manage the channel and control the keys, and from which I make occasional Lightning and on-chain payments. It's a decent enough privacy-custody trade-off adjusted by the size of the stack and relevant value. **I keep way more sats there than I do custodial, and way more in custodial than I do in CCs on SN.**

Every time I buy CCs to post or zap, I use a Lightning interface. When easily accessible sats run dry (Primal, Alby, Blink) I top up via Phoenix.

Those are all Lightning transaction, me using LN in a convenient way. **What's so wrong with that?**

Is there some sort of divine obligation imploring me to make any monetary transaction, however minor, the strongest, most private and most censorship-resistant ever?

In Bitcoin there's always a bigger fish, a more cypherpunk setup, a dude with a better, more private or more custodial collection of wallets and channels than you. *Big deal.* Being at different stages is fine; it's not even a moral imperative to move upward into ever-more complicated and noncustodial setups. Spreading them out and using the right tool for the right job is perfectly reasonable.

Am I a fake maxi or not a good Bitcoiner because I can't be arsed to deal with the constant headaches of running a Lightning node from which to pay minuscule sums daily for some comment on a pretty fringe website? No, def not.

Am I a fake maxi or not a good Bitcoiner because I'd rather make a bundled payment now and again for enough CCs that'll last me a week or so, rather than fiddle with a technical setup that sends sats from me to receiver *every single time*? (Yes, I understand that I'm pushing the problem onto everybody else, having to dispose of these CCs, but what makes them distinctively less shitcoiny is that they quickly become *real sats in rewards* for those of us who use them.)

complete this read online.
it's good

The Rise & Fall of Stacker News - P2P V4V sats denominated social media platform



110.5k sats \ 21 comments \ @Solomonsatoshi 24 Feb
news bitcoin Politics_And_Law econ bitcoinplusplus

Stacker News- an experiment in enabling global use of Bitcoin as a payments protocol and self moderating and funding social media experience.

Bitcoin was created as a P2P payment protocol.

Its creator knew that to reveal his identity would be to imperil both him/herself and the protocol.

So it was created to be capable of operating without any founder or centralised owner.

It was and remains an experiment in whether you can operate a monetary system via an algorithm and blockchain in a decentralised manner.

Bitcoin treats all participants equally without fear or favour while being resistant to censorship.

This presented a real challenge to the fiat monetary system that dominates all MoE globally.

Most autocracies banned the use of Bitcoin as a MoE while the 'wests' liberal democracies' imposed more subtle barriers to use short of an outright ban but relying more on subtle tax obligations which make lawful use of Bitcoin as a payment protocol effectively impractical...while allowing its use as a speculative commodity and the accumulation of more and more Bitcoin into speculative holding where it would not be used as a P2P payments protocol. Today there are very few opportunities to use Bitcoin as a payment- a few businesses accept it - but very few and far between.

The idea of using Bitcoin for micropayments in V4V social media platform via a second level Lightning Network had been suggested and provided a potential use case where Bitcoin could be used regularly and often.

Stacker News was established to test this idea.

Central to the idea was that all posts and comments cost those making them while consumers of content can reward content providers with real money (BTC) payments made in appreciation for the content.

Spam would be minimised as it costs to post or comment anything.

Good content would be rewarded with real money while nonsense and trolling would not earn any reward.

This had the potential to show BTC in use on a global scale.

Stacker News started and was growing, attracting decent content...

At that point Stacker News opted for a compromise solution using an inhouse token known as Cowboy Credit and where participants could attach a Lightning Network wallet the option to still use Bitcoin.

This change introduced substantial complexity and entry barriers to new participants if they wanted to still use sats.

Many did attach LN wallets but some did not.

Many chose to only attach a receiving wallet so that others could zap their content and they would receive any sats sent, but they would not be sending sats if they made payments.

The whole model had always required enough content consumers with attached wallets paying real money into the system (or buying CCs with real money) for it ever hope to be a viable economic concern.

It never happened.

There were never enough people buying content with BTC/sats for the SNs economy to become self sustaining.

The shift to a hybrid model created too much friction and ambiguity for content consumers to join and fund the platform. The introduction of CCs was a bit like the

end of the gold standard- CCs were not real money- they were not Bitcoin- they could be used without limit by Stacker News but had no value outside of the platform.

Many content providers cynically only attached receiving wallets so they could still milk real money (sats) from other participants, but if they ever paid for posts, comments or zaps they would only be using CC shitcoins.

The Stacker News economy never reached exit velocity- it has been an interesting attempt to build a platform that could have provided all people globally with a place and use case to use Bitcoin every day.

But this opportunity for Bitcoin use as a P2P payments protocol of global reach looks to have been obstructed and killed by a combination of state pressure and human greed

and selfishness.

Could such a model still succeed?

Yes quite probably.

There are Bitcoiners globally who would want to use Bitcoin in such a way.

How could it be improved?

The complexity and ambiguity introduced by having to use an inhouse token would ideally be avoided.

This might be achieved by operating from a jurisdiction where you will not be threatened or at risk from state bullying and prosecution. El Salvador maybe could host such a platform?

Or using the model of attached wallets from the start- this (probably) avoids the risk of prosecution and avoids the debasement of the platform economy with inhouse shitcoins- but it leaves the problem of attracting enough participants to reach critical mass and sufficient quality of content and users who will pay real money (sats) for that content....

Mt.Gox Collapse (850,000 Bitcoins Lost) - FULL STORY

8844 sats \ 21 comments \
@raw_avocado 25 Feb bitcoin



On this day
12 years ago,

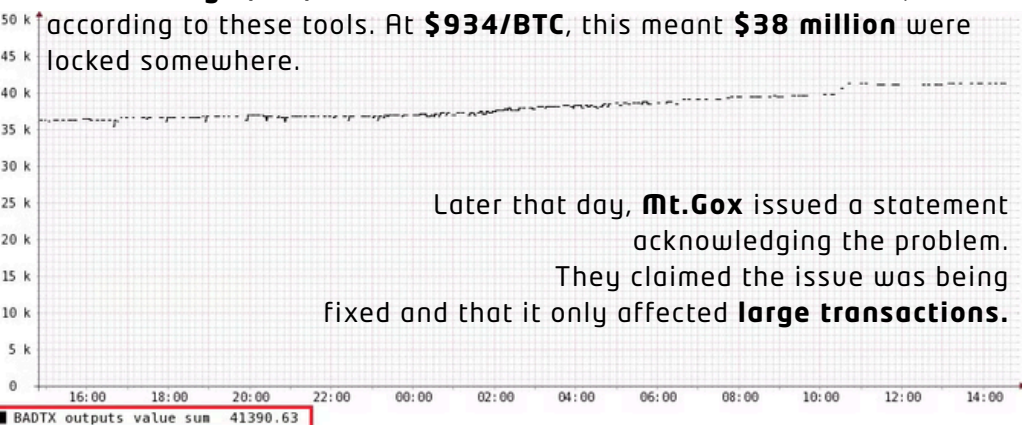
Mt. Gox suspended its operations.

This imploded the exchange and revealed that **850,000 bitcoin** had been lost.

This is: *The build up, The aftermath & The behind the scenes.*

Mt. Gox had a **public API** that would broadcast the status of internal TXs, withdrawals, etc. So at the time, several **community-built tools** monitored the exchange using the API.

On **February 4**, **41,390 BTC** were in "**BAD Transaction**" status, according to these tools. At **\$934/BTC**, this meant **\$38 million** were locked somewhere.



Source: <https://talkinge.net/2014/02/04/major-bitcoin-exchange-not-executing-withdrawals-now-owes-clients-38m-in-disappeared-money/>

complete this read online.

By the **6th of February**, tension was rising in the community, and people were growing **more suspicious**.

keithers
Jr. Member
Activity: 56
Ignore

Re: **Mt.Gox SCAM? \$38million disappeared. Large sums affected.**
February 06, 2014, 04:30:21 AM
#3

I said this in another thread, but I have a bad feeling that the people at Gox have been using user's funds for themselves and only processing withdrawals when there are sufficient new deposits. It was working before because such huge sums of money kept getting deposited, but its starting to pile up. Seems like it could be exactly what Ultimate Bet was doing with online poker player funds. I could be completely wrong, but something is definitely up. Claiming the site was hacked would be an easy out at first..

Source: <https://web.archive.org/web/20140208102920/https://bitcointalk.org/index.php?topic=451225.0>

On the **7th of February**, **Mt. Gox** released another press release. This time, they claimed that the increased flow of withdrawals had "*hindered them from a technical level.*" In order to fix the issue, they needed to **temporarily pause all withdrawals**.

On **February 10**, **Mt. Gox** released another statement. They claimed that the reason they encountered all these problems was **transaction malleability**.

Before the **SegWit** upgrade, someone could change some small data in a Bitcoin transaction, resulting in two versions of the same transaction on the Bitcoin network.

Both transactions would be valid but *of course*, only one would ultimately be confirmed in blocks.

Both transactions are spent using the same private key, so an adversary who malleates your transactions **cannot actually steal your bitcoins**. In most cases, this was more of an **annoyance** than a serious security vulnerability (when using **non-custodial wallets**, of course).

This issue was already **well known** at the time and was simply a consequence of how **Satoshi** designed Bitcoin transactions.

In **Mt. Gox's** case, this *could* have indeed been a genuine problem. A user could request a withdrawal, then malleate the transaction so that **two versions** appeared on the Bitcoin network:

- One that would confirm and send the funds to the user
- And a mutant (invalid) one that looked similar but would not confirm.

Mt. Gox's software would only detect the mutant/bad transaction (which failed to confirm), it would think there was some kind of issue and **fail to recognize** that the withdrawal had actually succeeded.

As a result, the attacker could **withdraw bitcoins** from **Mt. Gox** to their own wallet while **tricking the exchange** into believing the withdrawal had failed...

Meme Monday - Top Meme Goes in the Newsletter



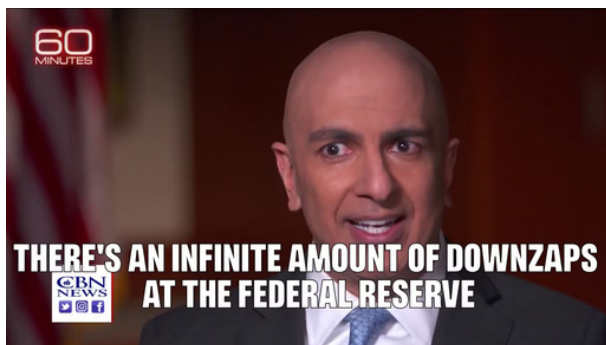
361 sats \ 20 comments
 \ @sn 23 Feb memes



231 sats \ 0 replies \ @Oxbitcoiner 23 Feb



133 sats \ 0 replies \ @Lux 23 Feb



Does having more pools reduce mining centralization pressure?



14.7k sats \ 23 comments \ @Scoresby 26 Feb bitcoin

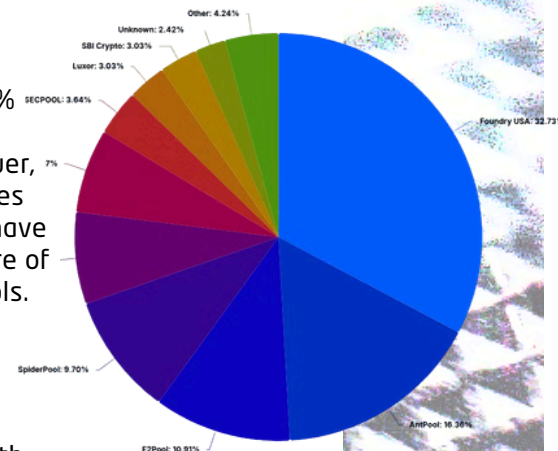
The problem with Bitcoin is that mining pools tend to get bigger
 In Bitcoin mining, there's a number of reasons to get in a pool. Two of these reasons are variance and latency.

- **Variance.** A miner working by themselves has to wait until they find a block to get paid (really, they have to wait until they find a block and then wait another 100 blocks because block subsidies can't be spent immediately). But all along (perhaps long before they actually get any bitcoin), they have to pay power bills and whatever other bills they have. This is called variance. If you work with a pool, maybe you can find blocks more frequently and help each other by splitting the rewards.
- **Latency.** Miners also have this problem where the longer it takes them to learn about a new block, the worse off they are. If you have a miner and you're grinding along trying to find a block but you don't know there's already a new block that's been found and all the other miners are building on top of that one, you might be wasting your hash power. You want to be building on a new block as soon as you possibly can. However long it takes you to learn about a block is the size of your disadvantage. If you work with a pool, especially a big one, maybe they can help cut down the latency (every time your pool finds a block, you learn about it very quickly -- the bigger your pool, the more likely they are to find blocks).

Because of these two reasons, and things like economies of scale, large pools have an advantage over smaller miners operating on their own -- which means smaller miners have an incentive to join pools, which means mining pools tend to get bigger.

Big pools are big bad

Everybody knows that one of the major risks for Bitcoin is a 51% attack. If one entity gains control of more than half the mining power, the censorship resistant properties of Bitcoin begin to weaken. You have probably seen a chart of the share of hash rate wielded by various pools. Lately it looks like this:



Foundry USA has found just over 30% of the blocks in the last month...

complete this read online.



Research in Public #13: Internal Department Feedback

11.7k sats \ 16 comments \ @SimpleStacker 20h econ

Research in Public #13: Internal Department Feedback[1]

Yesterday, I had a chance to present my research on Stacker News in front of my department. In the spirit of keeping the entire research process open, you can find the slides I used here.

As a reminder, the title of the work is **"Financial micro-incentives and internet discourse: Evidence from a Bitcoin based discussion platform"**.

In it, I use Stacker News data to test the following three hypotheses:

1. Higher posting costs leads to fewer posts in a territory, but higher quality posts.
2. The types of content that are better rewarded by zaps will increase in prevalence over time, as users learn that those kinds of content are better rewarded.
3. Consistently unprofitable users are more likely to exit the platform, while consistently profitable users are more likely to stay.

Without belaboring the empirical details (you can read all the past updates and results here), the short answer is that we find evidence consistent with each of the hypotheses, and that the financial micro-incentives are causal---that is, the posting cost and zap incentives on Stacker News are observably driving user behavior. Results suggest that even these small micro-incentives on the order of 1-100 sats are enough to drive behavior and post quality on the platform. Overall, the presentation was very well received. They seemed genuinely interested in SN's market based mechanisms, and their interest was also piqued when I told them that the users on SN really love to hear about economics. As a bunch of econ professors, we're not exactly used to hearing that. One guy also got really excited about the idea of downzapping, and he said he might come on the platform just to start blasting people (while making gun gestures, he has a humorous rebellious personality like that). I told him he's welcome to come on, so if you start getting randomly downzapped by a mysterious stranger---it's my fault, sorry in advance.

There weren't too many critiques of the empirical methodology, which I was hoping for more of actually. But I did get some insightful high level critiques, most of which I probably won't be able to address. Here they are, since they offer some food for thought for all Stackers:

- Since the topic was internet discourse, one person straight up asked if we could have better discourse by requiring people disclose their real identities online. I told her that it's a possibility, but that the people on this platform would likely be ideologically opposed to that. What would y'all have responded?
- Another insightful critique was the definition of quality. One person pointed out that what counts for quality on Stacker News might not be considered quality in the general population. I had to admit that my evidence only shows how the incentives work within the highly selected subpopulation of Stacker News users.
- Same person asked about echo chamber effects. I had to admit that indeed these incentives could potentially produce an echo chamber of views. Does anyone have any thoughts, or a better response to this?
- Another person pointed out that 200,000 posts and 11,000 users is tiny (ouch, @k00b), and thus we can't say much about social media more generally. Again, I was forced to admit that was correct. But before I could defend the paper, someone else defended it for me, saying that even if it's not generalizable, this is still a novel dataset that can speak to the issue and is worth investigating. I think in terms of the paper gaining broader acceptance as a serious scientific study, the small size of Stacker News as a platform might be one of the biggest barriers.
- There were some questions about whether people also took the Bitcoin price into consideration when posting on Stacker News. I actually don't have any good evidence of that. I told them that I think most SN users anchor their mental calculations to sats while on SN, and thus the cost denominated in sats matters more on the platform than the Bitcoin/USD exchange rate. What say you all?

Despite these high level critiques, everyone thought it was pretty cool and there were a lot of questions. I had a chance to tell people about the Lightning Network, which most had not heard of before, and how it enables instantaneous, global, peer-to-peer transactions. I venture to guess that the people left the room with a better impression of Bitcoin than they had when they entered it.

Well, that's it. The paper got rejected from the University of Wyoming Bitcoin Conference that first motivated me to start the project, so that was a bummer. But I think the paper is inherently interesting and I'm gonna try to see if I can submit it to some other conferences. We'll see how it goes. This paper isn't in the subfield that I've spent most of my career in, so getting a foot in the door may be hard.

Note: This is a series in which I am publicly documenting the research process for an academic study into financial micro-incentives on discussion platforms, using data from Stacker.News. See  for a list of updates. [↗](#)

